

ESL NEWS STORIES

Level-graded English lessons with reading, listening, activities, and discussion.

Lesson Info

Type	Level
Article	2 / A2
Published	Title
Jul 22, 2026	Smelling Chocolate Could Help You Exercise
Webpage	
https://eslnewsstories.com/articles/2026-07-22-smelling-chocolate-could-help-you-exercise/	

Lesson Content

- Warm-up, Vocab List, Reading and Audio
- Understanding: Main Idea, True or False, Multiple Choice
- Language: Vocab Match, New Sentences
- Use It: Discussion Builder, Discussion Questions
- Answers

Smelling Chocolate Could Help You Exercise

Think Ahead: Which detail do you think appears in the story?

- a) Water has a strong smell.
- b) Smelling chocolate made people want to eat chocolate.
- c) Dark chocolate made people feel less hungry.



Dark chocolate, milk chocolate.

Vocab List

researcher (n.) — A person who studies something to discover new information.

experiment (n.) — A scientific test used to learn about something.

rep (n.) — One repetition, or one complete movement of an exercise.

performance (n.) — How well someone does an activity.

scent (n.) — A smell, usually a pleasant one.

appetite (n.) — The feeling that you want to eat.

effect (n.) — A change caused by something.

pleasant (adj.) — Enjoyable or nice.

Smelling Chocolate Could Help You Exercise

Could the smell of chocolate help you exercise longer? A new study suggests that it might.

Researchers asked a group of young men to smell dark chocolate, milk chocolate, or water before and during a leg exercise. All of the men lifted weights regularly. During the experiment, they smelled the chocolate but did not eat it.

After smelling chocolate, the men were able to do more reps. Dark chocolate had the strongest effect, while milk chocolate also improved their performance.

The two scents seemed to work differently. Dark chocolate reduced the men's appetite, so they felt less hungry. However, they found the sweeter smell of milk chocolate more pleasant. Researchers are not yet sure why either scent helped them exercise longer.

The results are surprising. The study was small and only included young men who exercised regularly. Researchers now want to repeat the experiment with different groups to learn more about how smells affect exercise.

1. Main Idea

Choose one:

- ☐ Smelling chocolate may help people exercise longer.
- ☐ Dark chocolate may make people feel less hungry during exercise.
- ☐ Young men found milk chocolate more pleasant than dark chocolate.

2. True or False

1. The men ate chocolate before doing the leg exercise. TRUE FALSE
2. Milk chocolate had a stronger effect than dark chocolate. TRUE FALSE
3. The men found the smell of milk chocolate more pleasant. TRUE FALSE

3. Multiple Choice

1. What did the men smell during the experiment?

- a) Dark chocolate, milk chocolate, or water
- b) Dark chocolate, coffee, or water
- c) Milk chocolate, fruit, or coffee

2. What happened after the men smelled chocolate?

- a) They became tired more quickly.
- b) They were able to do more reps.
- c) They lifted heavier weights.

3. Why do researchers want to repeat the experiment?

- a) They want to test more kinds of chocolate.
- b) They want the men to eat chocolate next time.
- c) They want to study different groups of people.

4. Listen and Fill Gaps

Listen to the audio on esnewsstories.com and complete the gaps below:

Could the smell of chocolate help you exercise longer? A new (1) _____ suggests that it might.

Researchers asked a group of young men to smell dark chocolate, milk chocolate, or water before and during a leg exercise. All of the men lifted weights regularly. During the (2) _____, they smelled the chocolate but did not eat it.

After smelling chocolate, the men were able to do more (3) _____. Dark chocolate had the strongest effect, while milk chocolate also improved their performance.

The two scents seemed to work differently. Dark chocolate reduced the men's (4) _____, so they felt less hungry. However, they found the sweeter smell of milk chocolate more pleasant. Researchers are not yet sure why either scent helped them exercise longer.

The results are surprising. The study was small and only included young men who exercised regularly. Researchers now want to repeat the experiment with different (5) _____ to learn more about how smells affect exercise.

5. Vocab Match

Write each vocabulary word next to its matching definition.

- | | |
|--------------------|--|
| 1. Rep (n) | a) _____ A change caused by something. |
| 2. Performance (n) | b) _____ The feeling that you want to eat. |
| 3. Scent (n) | c) _____ A smell, usually a pleasant one. |
| 4. Appetite (n) | d) _____ How well someone does an activity. |
| 5. Effect (n) | e) _____ One complete movement of an exercise. |

6. New Sentences

appetite / effect / performance / reps / scent

1. I usually do ten _____ of each exercise.
2. The team is working to improve its _____.
3. The flowers gave the room a sweet _____.
4. The long walk gave me a big _____.
5. The medicine had no _____ on my headache.

7. Discussion Builder

Choose the best phrase for each gap:

1. Q: Do you think pleasant smells can help people do things? Why or why not?

A: Pleasant smells are helpful _____ they make people feel good and think positively.

because / but / so

2. Q: What helps you keep going when exercise becomes difficult?

A: Music can help me forget I'm tired, _____ I listen to music with a fast beat.

so / because / but

3. Dark chocolate and milk chocolate are both nice, _____ dark chocolate seems stronger.

but / because / so

8. Discussion Questions

1. Do you like the smell of chocolate? If not, what smells better?
2. Do you think pleasant smells can help people do things? Why or why not?
3. Would you try smelling chocolate during a workout? Why or why not?
4. What helps you keep going when exercise becomes difficult?
5. Why might dark chocolate and milk chocolate have different effects?
6. Would you rather eat chocolate or exercise?
7. Do you do leg exercises? How do you exercise your legs?
8. What other scents could researchers test during exercise?

Answers · Smelling Chocolate Could Help You Exercise / Level 2

Listening: (1) study, (2) experiment, (3) reps, (4) appetite, (5) groups

Main Idea: Smelling chocolate may help people exercise longer.

True or False:

1. False. They smelled the chocolate but did not eat it.
2. False. Dark chocolate had the strongest effect.
3. True. They found its sweeter smell more pleasant.

Multiple Choice: a, b, c

Vocabulary:

1. Rep (n): One complete movement of an exercise.
2. Performance (n): How well someone does an activity.
3. Scent (n): A smell, usually a pleasant one.
4. Appetite (n): The feeling that you want to eat.
5. Effect (n): A change caused by something.

New Sentences: 1. reps; 2. performance; 3. scent; 4. appetite; 5. effect

Discussion Builder:

Hints: 1) Reason. 2) Result. 3) Contrast.

1. because
2. so
3. but

ESL NEWS STORIES

Read, listen, learn, and discuss.

eslnewsstories.com